3. The Matses Hunter Boy (20 marks)

Problem designed by Abhishek Dedhe

Deep in the Peruvian Amazon, there is a small village inhabited by members of the Matses tribe. Read the following story about a young (and slightly arrogant) Matses boy called Abhishek.

A) One fine day, Abhishek decides to go hunting in the woods. He comes across fresh footprints of wild pigs on the ground. Being an accomplished hunter, he infers that wild pigs had passed by not long ago. Shortly after that (within a few hours), he meets a group of friends who are also hunting wild pigs and says to them – "**They passed by**."

B) The next day, Abhishek decides to go hunting again. This time he comes across old footprints of wild pigs. He realizes that these are from the last hunting season. A few hours later, he meets his friends who have also decided to spend the day hunting wild pigs (again)! Abhishek tells his friends – "**They passed by**."

C) Next year, Abhishek attends a Hunting Seminar. While boasting about his skills as a hunter, he tells the Committee about the time he had discovered fresh footprints of wild pigs and how he had inferred that – "**They passed by**".

D) During the meeting, Abhishek realizes that the Seminar is being held in a hut that was very recently built by a different Native American tribe (not the Matses Tribe). Abhishek observes – "**Non-Matses Indians built a hut**."

E) After the Seminar ends, Abhishek goes to Lima, the capital of Peru. He sees a cathedral, and finds out that it was built by the Spanish during the colonial era. He exclaims – "**Foreigners built a hut.**"

F) When he returns to his village after a year, he tells his friends about the cathedral he had seen in Lima – "**Foreigners built a hut.**"

The translations of the Abhishek's sentences (A-E) are given below (in no particular order):

1. *matses-utsi bëste-wa-ak-o-ṣh*
2. *chotac bëste-wa-nëdak-onda-ṣh*
3. *chotac bëste-wa-nëdak-o-ṣh*
4. *kuen-nëdak-o-ṣh*
5. *kuen-ak-onda-ṣh*
6. *kuen-ak-o-ṣh*

Assignment 1 [Answer-Booklet]: Determine the correct correspondences.

Assignment 2 [Answer-Booklet]: Give the Matses translations of Abhishek's sentences (in bold) from the scenarios described below.

a) During the Hunting Seminar, Abhishek describes to the Committee how he was able to identify the footprints of wild pigs that were very old (from the last hunting season). He boasts that he was able to infer that – "**They passed by.**"

b) During his tour of Peru, Abhishek goes to see the Machu Picchu (an ancient architectural marvel - often counted among the Seven Wonders of the World). Having grown up in a very small village, Abhishek does not know anything about the Machu Picchu, and thus decides to read about its history from a tourist brochure. He learns that it was built by the Inca people. However, Abhishek is unimpressed, and immediately makes an arrogant comment about the Machu Picchu - "**Non-Matses Indians built a hut**."

c) After touring Peru for more than a year, Abhishek returns to his village. He is dismayed to see that his lavish mansion had fallen into ruins. In its place is a small, shabby hut. Abhishek is told that this hut was built by the kind-hearted locals just a few days ago. Humbled and ashamed, Abhishek falls to his knees and cries out – "**Matses Indians built a hut.**"

Assignment 3: Translate this sentence to English: "Abhishek bëste-wa-nëdak-onda-şh". Let your imagination run wild and come up with an appropriate context in which you might utter this sentence! (Try to avoid ambiguous scenarios).

Assignment 4: Explain your solution.
